

GEOGRAPHY

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY



INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY

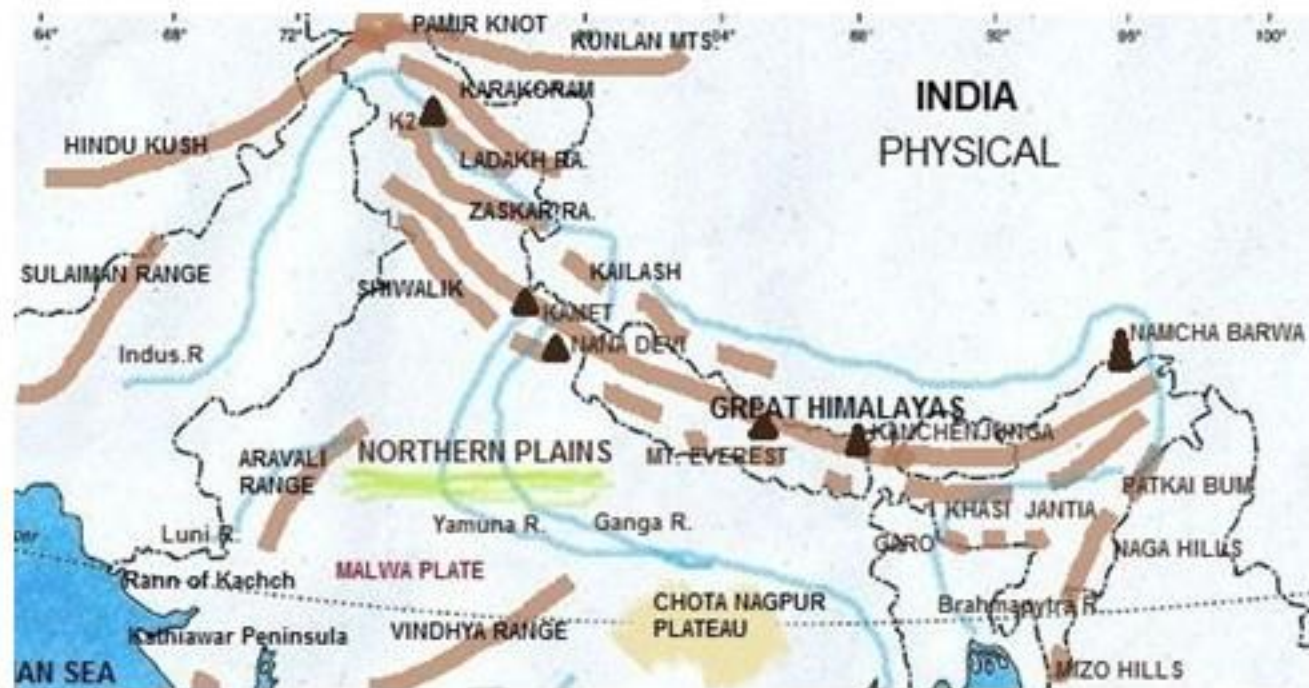
MODULE - 2

PHYSIOGRAPHIC DIVISIONS

- **HIMALAYAN RANGES**

1

THE NORTHERN AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS



Geographically the entire Himalayan region can be divided into three ranges

1. The Himalayan ranges
 - a) Shiwalik or Outer Himalayas
 - b) Lesser or Middle Himalayas
 - c) The Greater Himalayas
2. Trans Himalayas
3. Eastern hills or Purvanchal

1

THE NORTHERN AND
NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

2

TRANS HIMALAYAN RANGES



1

The Himalayan ranges immediately north of the Great Himalayas are called Trans Himalayas

2

The Zaskar, the Ladakh, the Kailas and the Karakoram are the main ranges of Trans Himalayan system.

3

It stretches for a distance of about 1,000 km in east-west direction.

4

Average elevation is 3000 m above mean sea level.

1

THE NORTHERN AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

2

TRANS HIMALAYAN RANGES



5

The Nanga Parbat forms the culmination of Trans Himalayas in the northwestern end.

6

North of the Zaskar Range and running parallel to it is the **Ladakh Range**.

7

River Indus originates from the northern slopes of the Kailas range.

8

The northern most range of the Trans-Himalayan Ranges in India is the **Great Karakoram Range**.

1

THE NORTHERN AND
NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

2

TRANS HIMALAYAN RANGES

9

Karakoram Range extends eastwards from the Pamir for about 800 km.



Godwin Austen or K2

10

It is the abode of some of the greatest glaciers of the world outside the polar region. Also it forms India's frontier with Afghanistan and China.

11

Some of the peaks in the Trans Himalayan system are more than 8,000 meters above sea level. **K2** also known as **Godwin Austen** is the **second highest peak** in the world and it is a part of the Karakoram range.

1

THE NORTHERN AND
NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

3

THE PURVANCHAL



1

The Himalayas take sudden southward turn and form a series of comparatively low hills running in the shape of a crescent with its convex side pointing towards the west.

2

These hills are collectively called the Purvanchal because they are located in the eastern part of the India.

3

In the north is the Patkai Bum, which forms the international boundary between Arunachal Pradesh and Myanmar.

INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY

1

THE NORTHERN AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

3

THE PURVANCHAL



4

After running for some distance southwards, it merges into **Naga hills**.

5

Patkai Bum and Naga hills form the watershed between India and Myanmar.

6

South of the Naga hills are **Manipur hills**, which are generally less than 2,500 meters in elevation.

INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY

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THE NORTHERN AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

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THE PURVANCHAL



7

Other important hills of the Purvanchal are Garo, Kasi and Jaintia hills, which are eastward continuation of the Indian peninsular block.

8

They are separated from the main block by the Ganga and the Brahmaputra rivers.

9

South of the Manipur hills are the Mizo hills, which was previously known as the Lushai hills, which have an elevation of less than 1,500 metres. The highest point is the Blue mountain.



1

THE NORTHERN AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

Another way to divide the Northern and North-Eastern mountains, apart from the above mentioned classification, is its Longitudinal Division:

1

The North and Northeastern Mountains consist of the Himalayas and the Northeastern hills.

2

Some of the important ranges comprises of the Greater Himalayan range, the Trans-Himalayan range, and the Purvanchal ranges

3

The general orientation of these ranges is from northwest to the southeast direction in the northwestern part of India.

4

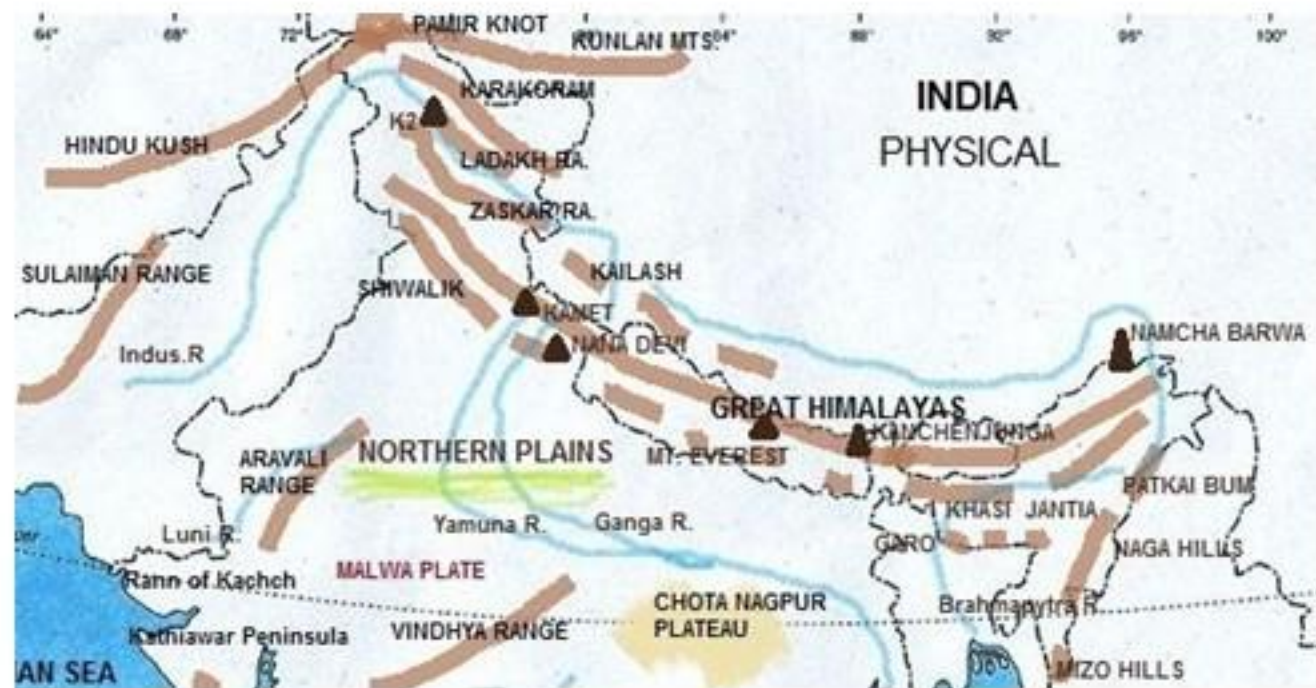
Himalayas in the Darjeeling and Sikkim regions lie in an east-west direction, while in Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram, they are in the north-south direction.

5

The approximate length of the Great Himalayan range, also known as the central axial range, is 2,500 km from east to west, and their width varies between 160-400 km from north to south.

1

THE NORTHERN AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS



6

It is also evident from the map that the Himalayas stand almost like a strong and long wall between the Indian subcontinent and the Central and East Asian countries.

7

Himalayas are not only the physical barrier, they are **also a climatic, drainage and cultural divide.**

8

There are large-scale regional variations within the Himalayas.

1

THE NORTHERN AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS



9

On the basis of relief, alignment of ranges and other geomorphological features, the Himalayas can be divided into the following sub-divisions:

- Kashmir or North-western Himalayas
- Himachal and Uttaranchal Himalayas
- Darjeeling and Sikkim Himalayas
- Arunachal Himalayas
- Eastern Hills and Mountains.

LONGITUDINAL DIVISION OF HIMALAYAS



THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

1 KASHMIR OR NORTHWESTERN HIMALAYAS



- 1 It comprise of a series of ranges such as the **Karakoram, Ladakh, Zaskar and Pir Panjal**.
- 2 The north-eastern part of the Kashmir Himalayas is a cold desert, which lies between the Greater Himalayas and the Karakoram ranges.
- 3 In this part of the Himalayas lies the world famous valley of Kashmir and the famous Dal Lake.
- 4 Important glaciers of South Asia such as the Baltoro and Siachen are also found in this region.

Karakoram Range

Ladakh Range

Zaskar Range

Pir Panjai

PAKISTAN

CHINA
(TIBET)

NEPAL

BHUTAN

BANGLADESH

I N D I A



INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

1 KASHMIR OR NORTHWESTERN HIMALAYAS

- 5 The Kashmir Himalayas are also famous for Karewa formations, which are useful for the cultivation of **Zafran**, a local variety of saffron. Karewas are the **thick lacustrine deposits of glacial clay and other materials embedded with moraines**.



THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

1 KASHMIR OR NORTHWESTERN HIMALAYAS



6 Some of the important passes of the region are ZojiLa on the Great Himalayas, Banihal on the Pir Panjal, Photu La on the Zaskar and Khardung La on the Ladakh range.

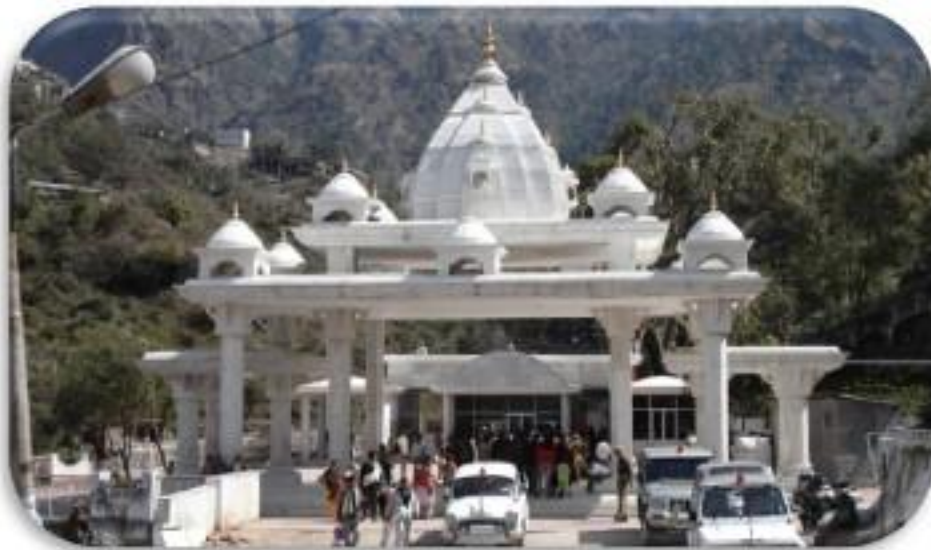
7 Some of the important fresh lakes such as Dal and Wular and salt water lakes such as Pangong Tso and Tso Moriri are also in this region.

8 This region is drained by the river Indus, and its tributaries such as the Jhelum and the Chenab.

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

1 KASHMIR OR NORTHWESTERN HIMALAYAS

- 9** The Kashmir and north-western Himalayas are well-known for their scenic beauty and picturesque landscape.



Vaishno devi temple

- 10** The landscape of Himalayas is a major source of attraction for adventure tourists.

- 11** Also some famous places of pilgrimage such as Vaishno Devi, Amarnath Cave, Charar -e-Sharif, etc. are also located here and large number of pilgrims visit these places every year.

- 12** Srinagar, capital city of the state of Jammu and Kashmir is located on the banks of Jhelum river. Dal Lake in Srinagar presents an interesting physical feature.

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

2 HIMACHAL AND UTTARANCHAL HIMALAYAS

- 1 This part lies approximately between the Ravi in the west and the Kali in the east.
- 2 It is drained by two major river systems of India, i.e. the Indus and the Ganga.
- 3 Tributaries of the Indus include the river Ravi, the Beas and the Satluj, and the tributaries of Ganga flowing through this region include the Yamuna and the Ghaghara.
- 4 The northernmost part of the Himachal Himalayas is an extension of the Ladakh cold desert, which lies in the **Spiti subdivision of district Lahul and Spiti**.
- 5 All the three ranges of Himalayas are prominent in this section also.
- 6 These are the Greater Himalayan range, the Lesser Himalayas (which is locally known as Dhauladhar in Himachal Pradesh and Nagtibha in Uttarakhand) and the Shiwalik range from the North to the South.

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

2 HIMACHAL AND UTTARANCHAL HIMALAYAS

- 7** In this section of Lesser Himalayas, the altitude between 1,000-2,000m specially attracted to the British colonial administration.



Dharamshala

- 8** Subsequently, some of the important hill stations such as Dharamshala, Mussoorie, Shimla, Kaosani and the **cantonment towns and health resorts** such as Shimla, Mussoorie, Kasauli, Almora, Lansdowne and Ranikhet, etc. were developed in this region.

- 9** The two distinguishing features of this region from the point of view of physiography are the 'Shiwalik' and 'Dun formations'.

Please refer to the last module for dun formation...

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

2 HIMACHAL AND UTTARANCHAL HIMALAYAS



Bhotia Tribe

10 Some important duns located in this region are the Chandigarh-Kalka dun, Nalagarh dun, Dehra Dun, Harike dun and the Kota dun, etc.

11 Dehra Dun is the largest of all the duns with an approximate length of 35-45 km and a width of 22-25 km.

12 In the Great Himalayan range, the valleys are mostly inhabited by the Bhotia's.

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

2 HIMACHAL AND UTTARANCHAL HIMALAYAS



Bugyals of Uttarakhand

- 13** These are nomadic groups who migrate to 'Bugyals' (the summer grass lands in the higher reaches) during summer months and return to the valleys during winters.
- 14** The famous 'Valley of flowers' is also situated in this region.
- 15** The places of pilgrimage such as the Gangotri, Yamunotri, Kedarnath, Badrinath and Hemkund Sahib are also situated in this part.

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

3

DARJILING AND SIKKIM HIMALAYAS



Map showing Tista river and Kangchenjunga

1

They are flanked by Nepal Himalayas in the west and Bhutan Himalayas in the east.

2

It is relatively small but is a very significant part of the Himalayas.

3

Known for its fast-flowing rivers such as Tista, it is a region of high mountain peaks like Kangchenjunga (Kanchengiri), and deep valleys.

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

3

DARJILING AND SIKKIM HIMALAYAS



Lepcha Tribe

4

The higher reaches of this region are inhabited by **Lepcha tribes** while the southern part, particularly the Darjiling Himalayas, has a mixed population of Nepalis, Bengalis and tribals from Central India.

5

The British, taking advantage of the physical conditions such as **moderate slope, thick soil cover with high organic content, well distributed rainfall throughout the year and mild winters**, introduced tea plantations in this region.

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

3

DARJILING AND SIKKIM HIMALAYAS



Duar formation

6

As compared to the other sections of the Himalayas, these along with the Arunachal Himalayas are **conspicuous** by the **absence of the Shiwalik formations**.

7

In place of the Shiwaliks here, the 'duar formations' are important, which have also been used for the development of tea gardens.

8

Sikkim and Darjiling Himalayas are also known for their scenic beauty and rich flora and fauna, particularly various **types of orchids**.

THE NORTH AND NORTHEASTERN MOUNTAINS

WHAT DO YOU UNDERSTAND BY THE WORD DUAR?



Duar formation

- 1 Duars are terai floodplains. They are made up of loose sediments brought down by Himalayan rivers and deposited each season.

- 2 Since they are fine sediments the streams, more often than not, shift course and spread the load over broad tracts.

- 3 Some streams disappear underground and reemerge only later. This makes duars very damp regions.

- 4 Duars may have considerable height and are great for growing crops like tea and coffee.

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